uity and modernity, opulence and engineering, imperfection and precision.

Global haute joaillerie has extraordinary technical traditions. Our point of difference is how we choose to integrate our manufacturing virtuosity into the brand aesthetic. Of course, Sabyasachi jewellery carries the abundance, patina, colour and emotional memory of India while focussing on construction and material integrity.

Josh Romm Sabyasachi's collection incorporates secular and religious motifs from the Byzantine era, transformed into elegant wearable designs in 18-and-22 carat gold accented with diamonds, garnets, tourmaline, lapis and other gemstones. These material choices reflect the dazzling range of materials and motifs that the Byzantine artisans would have used in their designs, and echo works on view at The Met.

Q. How will you balance the geopolitical specificities of ancient Western / near Eastern empires with the vocabulary of Indian karigari without flattening visible histories?

Sabyasachi Mukherjee Provenance protects identity; craftsmanship creates new relevance. A Roman object remains Roman. Byzantine iconography remains Byzantine. Persian, Egyptian or Greek histories retain their own cultural specificity. The Indian intervention happens through contemporary design and through the act of making.

We are not rewriting the history of the source object.; we are responding to it. That is why research and attribution are important, but so is transformation. In our studio, we seek to understand the spirit of an object rather than simply reproduce its appearance. Indian karigari then becomes a contemporary language through which that history can find another form. Civilisations have always developed through migration, trade and exchange. Byzantium is particularly interesting because it demonstrates that cultures were never as isolated as modern borders sometimes encourage us to believe.

Josh Romm Byzantine art is a powerful starting point for the inaugural Met x Sabyasachi collection because the era is so famously remembered for the exchange of ideas, creativity, and craftsmanship across numerous cultures. Interpreting historic works from around the globe through the unique lens of Indian karigari offers an opportunity for a fresh perspective that bridges cultures and time periods to create something exciting and new.



Q. Being a cross-cultural trading hub, the Byzantine Empire mirrors Sabyasachi's maximalist aesthetic and Kolkata roots, but will dictate future eras or non-jewellery categories for upcoming chapters of this multi-year collaboration?

Sabyasachi Mukherjee I don't want to treat 5,000 years of human creativity as a checklist. The chronology is less important to me than the possibility of transformation. An object has to provoke something emotionally or visually. Then we have to ask whether we can create something genuinely new from it, and whether Indian craftsmanship can add another dimension to its story.

That is why Byzantium was such a natural beginning. I understand cultures are created through multiplicity. Calcutta, New York and Byzantium are very different places, but all were shaped by the movement of people, goods and ideas. Their identity comes partly from what they absorbed.

Future chapters can move through different periods, geographies, materials and disciplines within The Met's extraordinary collection. The category will follow the idea. If an inspiration is better expressed through a garment, an accessory or another form of design, we will create it.

Josh Romm In every collaboration, The Met seeks to open its doors to designers and artisans to explore and find inspiration in the galleries. The creative process is inherently personal, and so we allow our collaborative partners free reign to visit, ask questions, and spend time with our team developing thoughtful narratives that offer insights into the past.

Q. What does the future hold for this partnership?

Sabyasachi Mukherjee This partnership gives us the ability to build chapters rather than chase moments. We can enter different departments, periods, geographies and forms of craftsmanship while allowing each collection to develop its own identity.

What excites me is the possibility of creating a continuous loop between history and contemporary culture. A customer may encounter an object through Sabyasachi and become curious about where it came from. That curiosity gives the collaboration meaning beyond just the product.

The Met preserves extraordinary evidence of what human beings have been capable of creating across millennia. At a time when our lives are becoming increasingly digital and increasingly homogenised, I think material culture, craftsmanship and objects made by human hands will become more important.

Our responsibility is to approach that history with respect, curiosity and enough confidence to create something new from it. If these pieces eventually become heirlooms themselves, then the circle is complete.